



AI Action Plan

Attn: Faisal D'Souza, NCO
2415 Eisenhower Avenue
Alexandria, VA 22314

Dear Mr. D'Souza,

The [Alliance for Learning Innovation \(ALI\)](#) brings together education nonprofits, philanthropy, and the private sector, to advocate for building a better research and development (R&D) infrastructure in education. Considering that R&D is a relatively untapped engine of innovation in the education sector, ALI advocates for increased capacity of education R&D and supports the research and development of evidence-based innovation that centers students and practitioners, advances equity, improves talent pathways, and expands the workforce needed in a globally competitive world.

Incoming Director Kratsios shared that he is "committed to American leadership in emerging technologies, and to ensuring that all Americans benefit from scientific and technological advances." The Alliance for Learning Innovation is ready to support this noble goal recognizing that a robust AI infrastructure requires a robust education R&D infrastructure. The time is now for a whole of government approach to AI.

ALI sees great promise in artificial intelligence (AI) to improve education, economic opportunity, and national security. To realize this opportunity and ensure the U.S. remains globally competitive, the nation needs a rigorous and modernized education R&D ecosystem that crosscuts federal agencies and taps into the promise of AI.

Stunning advancements in generative AI show the potential of what AI-powered and AI-enabled, research-based advancements in teaching and learning could do. With careful design, stakeholder engagement, and attention to research and development, AI can promote personalized and individualized learning supported by universal design for learning, improve student engagement and achievement and support human flourishing.

An updated education R&D ecosystem that leverages AI will cultivate generations of talent in the STEM fields, including AI, and lead to innovations that strengthen our national security, workforce preparedness, and global competitiveness. However, this cannot be accomplished without simultaneously investing in strong education R&D infrastructure and the underlying data infrastructure that helps us develop effective and safe applications of AI technologies in educational settings.

To realize the full potential of AI in learning environments and for innovation and to inform the development of the Trump administration's AI Action Plan, the Alliance for Learning Innovation recommends the following concrete policy actions:

1. **OSTP should coordinate with the Office of the Federal CIO on the revised M-Memo on AI** to advance education-related AI use cases, increase interagency cooperation on AI projects with K12 education components, and to partner with outside institutions to seed/accelerate AI technologies in education.
2. **Connect K-12 education and workforce development efforts across the federal government.** NSF does this effectively with its [Experiential Learning for Novel and Emerging Technologies](#) program, which builds career pathways in emerging technology fields and tracks for secondary and post-secondary school students, as well as adult learners. NSF's [Advanced Technological Education](#) program offers another example of K-12 and workforce connectivity, as it supports partnerships with secondary schools for budding science and engineering technicians as does [Biofab Explorer: Designing a Dual Enrollment Pathway to Careers in Biofabrication](#) which embeds career guidance into CTE classrooms that provide dual enrollment options to high school students. Similarly, since CTE has long utilized and supported career pathways, more could be done to ensure that CTE career pathways are being developed in relevant industries like semiconductor manufacturing and are connected to post-secondary pathway options. The Administration should create opportunities to increase the number of qualified instructors and allow flexibility for students to pursue career pathway opportunities outside traditional education structures. Without well-developed pathways that begin in K-12, the talent needed to continue to build on workforce development investments made by the federal government will be missing. Work-based learning

opportunities including youth apprenticeships, should be leveraged to address the career opportunities AI will create.

3. **Promote AI literacy through competitive grantmaking.** Establish a government wide AI literacy priority and utilize this priority in competitive grant competitions at relevant federal agencies. The priority should include a priority for programs or tools that increase AI literacy for students and/or educators, along with researchers in discretionary grant priorities.
4. **Ensure robust federal investments in AI and education R&D and the necessary data infrastructure.** Specifically, maintain the National AI Institutes program currently housed at the National Science Foundation (NSF) and the Accelerate, Transform, & Scale Initiative (ATS) currently housed at the Institute of Education Sciences (IES). NSF and IES co-funded the AI Institute for Exceptional Education, which capitalizes on the latest AI research to serve children with speech and language pathology needs, as well as the AI Institute for Inclusive Intelligent Technologies for Education, exploring the intersection of AI and skills, like persistence and collaboration, that underlie academic success. Communities must continue to benefit from AI Institutes that meet the moment and deliver solutions for today's teaching and learning challenges. Congress should also continue to fund the ATS Initiative at IES to support more U-GAIN R&D Centers, which provide rapid and responsive research around generative AI in schools and classrooms. We recommend the Administration include robust funding for these initiatives in their FY 2026 budget request.
5. **Pass the bipartisan CREATE AI Act and Future of Innovation Act.** Work with Congress to pass the theCREATE AI Act, which would authorize the National Artificial Intelligence Research Resource (NAIRR) and democratize the development and use of AI. The NAIRR would provide free or low-cost access to datasets and computing resources and bolster American innovation in many fields, including education and workforce pathways. The Future of Innovation Act would advance AI research by forging partnerships among government, business, civil society, and academia. This legislation would create testbeds with national laboratories to spur groundbreaking AI innovations, including in education, that will strengthen the U.S. economy and national security.
6. **Maintain sufficient resources for the Discovery Research PreK-12 Program Resource Center on Transformative Education Research and Translation (DRK-12 RC) program at NSF.** The DRK-12 RC program is intended to select

partners to enhance the overall influence and reach of the DRK-12 Program's research and development investments. The DRK-12 RC program could be utilized to work with multi-sector constituencies to accelerate the identification and scaling of evidence-based practices for AI, computer science, data science, and other emerging technologies.

7. **Establish a National Center for Advanced Development in Education (NCADE).** Modeled after the successful Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency (DARPA), this new Center would:
 - a. Fund informed-risk, high-reward research projects that have the potential to make transformative breakthroughs in AI, career-connected learning, and STEM literacy among other educational opportunities.
 - b. Facilitate interdisciplinary collaboration, bringing together experts from a diversity of sectors to collaboratively solve complex problems in education. Leading these teams of collaborators are program managers, who have autonomy to actively design and manage their portfolios, unlike grant program officers.
 - c. Use flexible funding mechanisms to rapidly deploy dollars to innovators and researchers tackling complex, urgent issues in education. For example, when using contracts (as opposed to grants), NCADE can ask for specific deliverables and hold awardees accountable to those deliverables.
8. **Promote policies and funding that support access to and use of the National Institute of Standards and Technology [Artificial Intelligence Risk Management Framework](#).** Developed in collaboration with the private and public sectors, the voluntary use framework is intended to improve the ability to incorporate trustworthiness considerations into the design, development, use, and evaluation of AI products, services, and systems.

In addition, ALI recommends that the Administration promote policies and funding that support access to and use of the National Institute of Standards and Technology [Artificial Intelligence Risk Management Framework](#) (NIST Framework) that improve the ability to incorporate trustworthiness considerations into AI products, services, and systems. ALI also urges use of the [Data Quality Campaign](#) and [EDSAFE AI Alliance's](#) policy recommendations to protect student data, privacy, and data quality in any AI learning tool. Please do not hesitate to reach out to Sara Schapiro, Executive Director

of the Alliance for Learning Innovation if you have any questions or if there is anything we can do to help.

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